

ON THE CRAFT OF

A CONTEMPORARY guide to WARGAME DESIGN

*A practical, opinionated guide to
designing historical board wargames*



RAY WEISS

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A Contemporary Guide to
WARGAME DESIGN



You do not need a giant game to learn wargame design.
You need a subject you care about, a clear idea of what
the players should be deciding, and enough discipline to
leave out the parts that do not matter.

This book is about that discipline.

Ray Weiss has designed and published nearly thirty
historical wargames. In *A Contemporary Guide to Wargame
Design*, he explains how those games get built: scope,
scale, maps, counters, combat, supply, morale, victory,
playtesting, rules writing, and publication. The advice
is practical because the problems are practical. How
much detail is enough? When is chrome helping? Why does
one system feel historical and another feel arbitrary?

Start small. Finish something. Learn from the table.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Ray Weiss is an independent wargame designer and the founder of Conflict
Simulations LLC, a small publishing company focused on historical board
wargames. He has designed and published nearly thirty games covering
conflicts from the German Peasants' War of 1525 to the Russo-Ukrainian
War. His work includes hex-and-counter, area-control, point-to-point, and
card-driven designs at tactical, operational, and strategic scales. His
games have been published by Multi-Man Publishing and nominated for
Charles S. Roberts Awards. One of his designs, **2022: Ukraine**, was
adopted by a NATO-member military for training exercises. **A Contemporary
Guide to Wargame Design** collects the lessons he learned by designing
games, making mistakes, and noticing why systems work.

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